

What Is a Stakeholder Analysis?

A stakeholder analysis is a [project management tool](#) used to identify the project's stakeholders, issues they care about and how they will be impacted by the project. Creating a stakeholder analysis will outline the essential people you need to communicate with about the progress and scope of the project, the topics you need to keep them informed about as the project progresses and how often you should speak to each stakeholder.

In this article, we cover what a stakeholder analysis is, how to conduct one, provide a sample stakeholder analysis and explain why it's important.

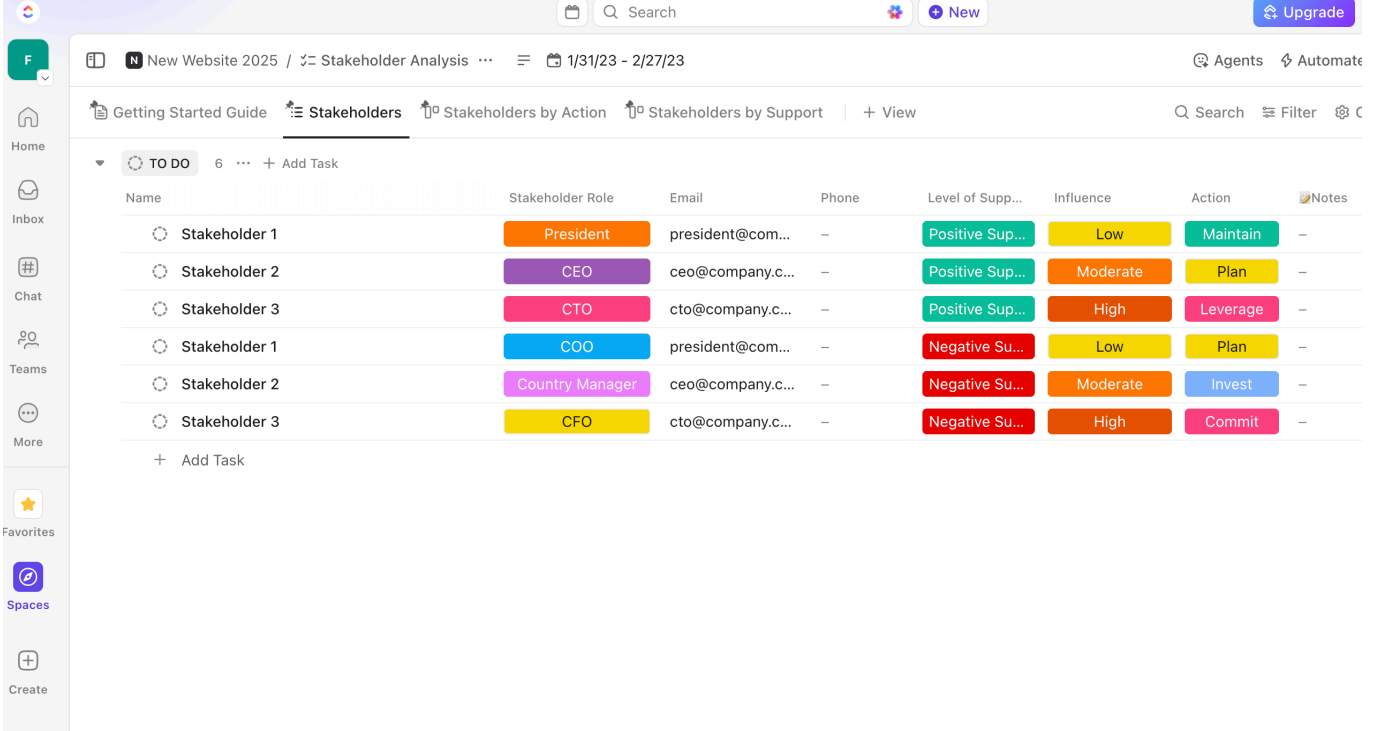
What Is a Stakeholder?

A stakeholder is a person or a group of people that has a vested interest in a project that you're working on. Each key stakeholder has the chance of being impacted by the project and its outcomes. So, who is a stakeholder? Project stakeholders can be employees, clients, suppliers and investors, to name a few.



Project stakeholders are individuals or a group of people who will be impacted, either positively or negatively, by the project you are working on.

needs of each stakeholder and their primary requirements. A stakeholder includes any person or group the project will impact, including investors, advisors, sponsors, team members and current or future customers.



The screenshot shows a ClickUp workspace for 'New Website 2025' with a 'Stakeholder Analysis' task. The task is marked as 'TO DO' and has 6 sub-tasks. The table below represents the data within this task.

Name	Stakeholder Role	Email	Phone	Level of Supp...	Influence	Action	Notes
Stakeholder 1	President	president@com...	—	Positive Sup...	Low	Maintain	—
Stakeholder 2	CEO	ceo@company.c...	—	Positive Sup...	Moderate	Plan	—
Stakeholder 3	CTO	cto@company.c...	—	Positive Sup...	High	Leverage	—
Stakeholder 1	COO	president@com...	—	Negative Su...	Low	Plan	—
Stakeholder 2	Country Manager	ceo@company.c...	—	Negative Su...	Moderate	Invest	—
Stakeholder 3	CFO	cto@company.c...	—	Negative Su...	High	Commit	—

Project management software, such as ClickUp, provides users with a stakeholder analysis template.

What Is the Purpose of a Stakeholder Analysis?

The purpose of a stakeholder analysis is to outline the key stakeholders and their needs at the start of the project. It is important to have a clear understanding of each stakeholder and what they expect, especially because stakeholders' needs and expectations may collide with each other or with the project's core requirements.

	Responsible	Accountable	Consulted	Informed	
	Task owner, accountable for completion.	Decision-maker, responsible for project success.	Provides input/advice, not responsible for completion.	Kept up-to-date, not involved in decision-making.	
Project Activity	Product Manager	Designer	Developer	QA Engineer	Content Manager
Define Audience & Goals	R	A	I	C	A
Create Wireframe	C	I	R	I	A
Create Sitemap	A	R	C	R	C
Design Layout	I	C	A	A	I
Develop Website	R	A	I	R	C
Test Functionality	I	R	C	C	R
Launch Website	C	A	I	C	A

After a stakeholder analysis, you can use a RACI chart to help you keep track of who is responsible, and who is accountable, consulted and informed.

After completing a stakeholder analysis, as well as using a stakeholder analysis template to help you keep track of information, you can use a [RACI chart](#) to help you identify which stakeholders are responsible, accountable, informed and consulted in relation to tasks. No matter what, you simply must notate everything you can to keep your stakeholder ducks in a row.

How To Conduct a Stakeholder Analysis

Conducting a stakeholder analysis starts with gathering enough information to understand each stakeholder's needs, according to Chris Mattmann, Chief Technology and Innovation Officer (CTIO) at NASA Jet Propulsion Laboratory. Typically, the designers on the team would interview each of the stakeholders to understand their processes, needs, limitations and interests.



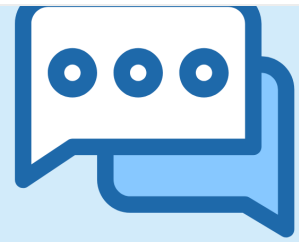
In person



Conference call



Video conference



Instant messaging

You can use any communication method to contact stakeholders when conducting a stakeholder analysis. Just be sure to gather as much information as you can.

Forbes ADVISOR

There are many ways to communicate with stakeholders.

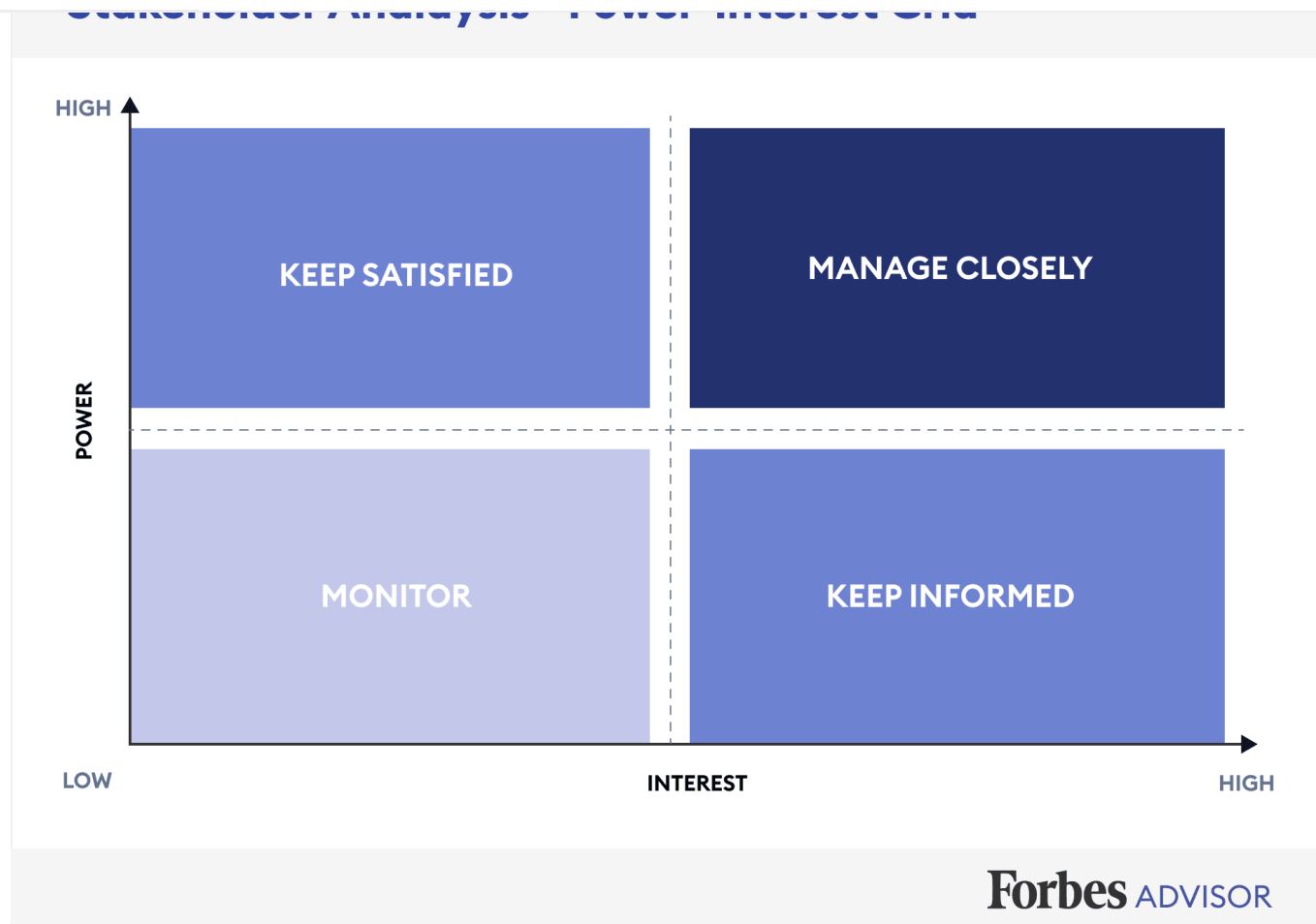
To illustrate this, Mattmann outlined a hypothetical project to measure and create a map of the water in the western United States. This would involve many different systems and teams, such as people to conduct field experiments, and equipment like airplanes, towers and satellites. To conduct the stakeholder analysis, the design team would interview each stakeholder, whether that be the sponsors, the data providers, the IT team or the project developers.

After collecting this raw data from interviews, the team would review the information from these discussions and start interpreting it. This is when the team might lay out a lot of sticky notes on the wall and start grouping them by requirement or, alternatively, use a software tool to outline the raw data. Essentially, the idea is to identify trends and possible points of conflict between the information each stakeholder shared in the interview.

“Part of stakeholder analysis is to do the interviews, design work, brainstorming, and then to map the results of that against your core requirements defined by the sponsors of the project and see if we can build them,” Mattmann explained. Once you compare the different feedback from stakeholders, you may find it doesn’t match up to the core requirements of the project. This might mean readjusting the project scope or reevaluating the direction of the project, but a stakeholder analysis will allow you to figure this out before the project begins.

Stakeholder Analysis Example

A stakeholder map will allow you to visually interpret how often you need to stay in contact with each stakeholder, how closely you should manage them and how to keep them satisfied and/or informed. To create a stakeholder map, you would define a few important dimensions, then build quadrants for the dimensions you want to optimize and group the stakeholder in that map, Mattmann explained.



A stakeholder analysis grid allows you to plot where each stakeholder falls.

Once you determine where each stakeholder falls on the table, you'll be able to determine how you communicate with each stakeholder.

"You want your most important stakeholders to be the most interested in your project," Mattmann explained. That may mean keeping daily communication with them. "You don't ever want to let their interest wane because they're the most important people," he said.

On the other hand, it may not be as high of a priority to communicate regularly with the stakeholders who have less influence or are going to be less impacted by the project. For these stakeholders, "you might not care if their interest in the project is low because they're not the most important stakeholders and they're not going to add a ton of value based on their influence," Mattmann added.

For example, in the initial example of the map to measure the water levels in the western U.S., a stakeholder analysis might outline how to communicate with the project's data providers. "What we should do is keep them informed, but we don't have to have day-to-day contact with them," Mattmann explained. "That way, we're managing our stakeholders not because they're the most

Here are some of the [best project management software](#) solutions that can help you create your own stakeholder analysis sheets and track projects.

ClickUp. With its robust collaborative documents, task and project management tools, and templates, teams using predictive [project management methodologies](#) and [agile frameworks](#) will find everything they need in ClickUp. You can learn more about the platform in our full [ClickUp review](#).

Monday.com. Those new to project management will appreciate how easy Monday.com is to use. Its colorful, intuitive interface, myriad templates and task management tools allow new teams to hit the ground running. You can learn more in our full [Monday.com review](#).

Teamwork.com. Robust finance and [resource planning](#) tools, as well as templates and task tools, make Teamwork.com a top choice for project teams. It's easy on the eye and as user-friendly as Monday.com. You can learn more in our full [Teamwork.com review](#).

The screenshot shows the Monday.com interface with a 'Stakeholder Register' template. The sidebar on the left contains navigation links: Home, My work, More, Favorites, Workspaces, Main workspace (recruitment pipeline), Employee directory, Employee Directory, Employee Directory, Directory Dashboard, New Doc, CRM, Basic CRM, Deal Tracker, Getting Started, My Contacts, Sales Dashboard, OKR - Q2 Brainstorming Session, RACI Chart, KPI, Gap Analysis, Resource Planning, Work Breakdown Structure, and Stakeholder Register. The main content area displays two tables for 'Project A' and 'Project B'. Each table has columns for Stakeholder, Point of Contact, Role, Internal/External, Title/Role, Impact Level, Level of Involvement, Stakeholder mapping, Involvement Milestones, Stakeholder Impact, Communication method, and Comments. Project A includes John Smith, Sarah Fish, Danielle L., and Jerome L. Project B includes Jess Bar, Maria TuL., and Ria Patel. The interface is colorful and includes various icons for actions like search, filter, and sort.

Monday.com makes it easy to track stakeholder involvement.

The Bottom Line

After reading this guide, we hope you now have a better understanding of what a stakeholder analysis is and why you should conduct one at the start of every project. A stakeholder analysis will help you understand the needs of all key stakeholders and what they will expect from the project. Do not skip over this important part of your project plan.

[Brett Day](#) also contributed to this article.